

Nissim Lebovits

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EXPERIENCE

Radiant Earth

Radiant Earth Fellow, Public-Interest Data Infrastructure · Contract · Jan 2026 – Present · Remote
Technical lead for Portolan, a standard for publishing geospatial data as cloud-native files on object storage, plus the tools that make it real. Structured metadata lets people and agents query a catalog directly, with no servers or databases to run. Core contributor to geoparquet-io, released on PyPI. Work with governments and civic organizations to publish public-interest data on commodity object storage through Source Cooperative.

University of Pennsylvania, Weitzman School of Design

Lecturer · Jan 2026 – Present · Philadelphia, PA

Co-teach the graduate course "Geospatial Machine Learning in Remote Sensing," rebuilding the curriculum around a cloud-native stack.

Universidad Nacional de La Plata

Fulbright Research Fellow · Mar 2025 – Dec 2025 · La Plata, Argentina

Built four pilot projects with Argentine municipalities on flood, wildfire, extreme heat, and informal settlements, identifying 10,000+ residents exposed to extreme heat in Pergamino and as many as 100,000 people missing from official settlement data in La Plata. Trained local officials to maintain the workflows independently. Designed and taught a graduate course on open data and cloud-native Python for municipal climate risk, now becoming an open-source multilingual book in Quarto.

Clean & Green Philly

Founder and Project Lead · Jul 2023 – Jul 2025 · Philadelphia, PA

Founded an open-source nonprofit platform that promotes data-driven interventions in vacant properties to improve quality of life in Philadelphia. Built the full-stack platform from prototype to production with a Next.js frontend and a Dockerized Python geospatial pipeline, coordinating 200+ Code for Philly volunteers across development, UX, data analysis, and domain expertise.

University of Pennsylvania

Research Associate, Prof. Allison Lassiter · Mar 2023 – Mar 2025 · Philadelphia, PA

Applied clustering algorithms (k-means, DBSCAN, GMM) with PCA to quantify climate risk across 4,500+ water suppliers in 11 states. Built a multi-agent model to simulate saltwater intrusion across three coastal regions, combining climate projections with supplier finances and network topology in reproducible Python, R, and ArcGIS workflows.

Research Associate, Prof. Matthijs Bouw · Nov 2023 – May 2024 · Philadelphia, PA

Built scalable ML pipelines with Python, Google Earth Engine, and Google Cloud for national-scale flood and heat risk assessment, running country-wide analysis from a single CLI command. Integrated results with population, vulnerability, and biodiversity data for a UN-Habitat initiative helping planners mitigate climate risk from urban expansion.

City of Philadelphia

Data and Evaluation VISTA · Jul 2021 – Jul 2022 · Philadelphia, PA

Built data collection and analysis pipelines in R and ArcGIS for the federally designated West Philadelphia Promise Zone, delivering dashboards and automated reports for non-technical stakeholders.

EDUCATION

University of Pennsylvania

Master of City Planning · Aug 2022 – May 2024

Vanderbilt University

Bachelor of Arts, History · Aug 2016 – May 2020

HONORS & AWARDS

Fulbright Research Grant, U.S. Department of State. 2025.

Gaia Award for Excellence in Environmental Planning, University of Pennsylvania. 2024.

Witte-Sakamoto Family Prize in City Planning, University of Pennsylvania. 2023.

LANGUAGES

English (native). Spanish (full professional proficiency).